Alyssa René Heinze

alyssaheinze.github.io

Academic Positions

Assistant Professor, University of California, Davis — starting 2027
Department of Political Science

Postdoctoral Fellow, Stanford University — 2026–27
King Center on Global Development
Working with Hélène Benveniste, Doerr School of Sustainability

Education

PhD in Political Science, University of California, Berkeley — 2026

MSc in Economics, *Mention très bien*, Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne — 2021

BA in Government, *Summa cum laude*, Dartmouth College — 2018

Book Project

Agriculture and Patriarchy: Growing and Severing the Roots of Male Dominance

Published Articles

4. "When Crises Entrench Gendered Power: Male Elite Adaptation in the Ugandan Parliament." *Legislative Studies Quarterly* 51.4 (2026): e70095, with Amanda Clayton, Cecilia Josefsson, and Pär Zetterberg.
3. "Democratic Deepening or Elite Persistence? How Local Elites Adapt to Electoral Reform in Rural India." *American Political Science Review* 120.3 (2026): 876–895.
   – Paula D. McClain Award for the MPSA Best Paper (2025)
   – MPSA Evan Ringquist Field Award for Best Paper on the Topic of Political Institutions (2025)
   – Philo Sherman Bennett Prize in Political Science (2024)
   – Honorable Mention, Center for the Study of Law and Society Paper Prize (2024)
2. "Inclusive Reforms as Levers for Social Exclusion: The Paradoxical Consequences of Quotas for Women in Rural India." *World Development* 196 (2025), with Rachel E. Brulé and Simon Chauchard.
1. "Who Actually Governs? Gender Inequality and Political Representation in Rural India." *The Journal of Politics* 87.2 (2025): 818–822, with Rachel E. Brulé and Simon Chauchard.

Working Papers

"Can Climate Change Disrupt Male Dominance?"

"Solidarity, Agency, and the Environment: RCT Evidence with Women Leaders in Rural India."
With Rachel E. Brulé and Bhumi Purohit. *Registered Report Submitted.*

"Feminized Victimhood: Marketing Global South Climate Change Adaptation Policy in the Global North."
With Allison Grossman and Leonardo Arriola. *Submitted.*

"Decentralizing Democratic Erosion: Local Election Suspensions in the World's Largest Democracy."
Under Review, with Pratik Mahajan.

PROJECTS IN PROGRESS

"Women Water Warriors: Bottom-Up Mobilization of Women for Water Governance in Rural India."

"The Gender Politics of Water: Patriarchal Control of Community Natural Resource Governance Institutions." With Aksel Sundström.

"Teaching Climate, Changing Minds? The Gendered Impact of a School-Based Intervention in Brazil." With Antonio Valentim and Guilherme Fasolin.

"Flipping the Script: Restructuring Deliberation in Patriarchal Political Institutions." With Rachel E. Brulé and Simon Chauchard.

AWARDS

2025 The Empirical Study of Gender (EGEN) Research Prize
2024 Paula D. McClain Award for the MPSA Best Paper
2024 Evan Ringquist Field Award for Best Paper on the Topic of Political Institutions
2024 Odegard Award for the 3rd-Year Student with Exceptional Performance
2024 Philo Sherman Bennett Prize in Political Science

GRANTS

2026 Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics Pilot Grant: $24,725
2024 CEGA Development Economics Challenge Grant: $20,000
APSA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant: $14,368
Fulbright-Hays Doctoral Dissertation Research Abroad Fellowship: $36,444
Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics Travel Grant: $4,698
Global Democracy Commons Pilot Research Project Grant: $2,000
CEGA Development Economics Challenge Grant: $20,000
Bhattacharya Graduate Fellowship Travel Grant: $1,000
ABD Fellowship in International Studies: $15,000
2023 CEGA Development Economics Challenge Grant: $5,000
Pre-Dissertation Grant in International Studies: $5,000
2022 Bhattacharya Graduate Fellowship Travel Grant: $1,000
CEGA Development Economics Challenge Grant: $4,965
2021 BU Foundation-India Seed Funding: $30,000 (with R. Brulé and B. Purohit)
2020 James B. Reynolds Scholarship for Masters Study: $25,000
Richard D. Lombard Public Service Research Fellowship: $20,000
2018 Fulbright-Nehru Research Fellowship: $20,000
Fulbright Critical Language Enhancement Award for Marathi Studies: $6,600
Neil T. McGorrian Fellowship for Marathi Studies: $5,500
Honors Thesis Grant from the Office of President Hanlon: $1,000
Nelson A. Rockefeller Center Honors Thesis Grant: $1,000
Undergraduate Advising and Research Honors Thesis Grant: $1,000

CONFERENCES AND INVITED TALKS

2027 (planned): UCLA: Research Lab on Climate Politics; Bocconi: AXA Research Lab on Gender Equality Seminar Series; University of Oslo; Uppsala University; University of Gothenburg

2026: Empirical Study of Gender Research Network Annual Conference (Stanford); MPSA Annual Conference & Three Decades of Research on India's Gender Quotas Conference-within-a-conference (Chicago);

Northeast Workshop in Empirical Political Science (NEWEPS); Gender and Political Polarization Workshop (Johns Hopkins); Penn: The Center for the Advanced Study of India Political Economy Workshop; EGEN / SUCCESS Conference (Bergen); European Conference on Politics and Gender (Newcastle); European Political Science Society Annual Conference (Belfast); APSA Annual Meeting (Boston); Conference on the Political Economy of Climate and Environment (PECE) (Harvard); Pre-APSA South Asia Political Economy of Development Workshop (Harvard); Working Group on South Asian Politics (Yale); The Distributive Consequences of Climate and Environmental Policy Mini-Conference (LSE); Indian Institute of Management, Indore; Ashoka University

2025: MPSA Annual Meeting (Chicago); APSA Annual Meeting (Vancouver); University of California, Davis; New York University, Abu Dhabi; University of Wisconsin, Madison

2024: Keynote Speaker, International Electoral Affairs Symposium (Jodhpur, India); European Conference on Politics and Gender (Ghent); MPSA Annual Meeting (Chicago); APSA Annual Meeting (Philadelphia)

2023: APSA Annual Meeting (Los Angeles); African Studies Association Annual Meeting (San Francisco)

2022: MPSA Annual Meeting (Chicago); RSCD Speaker Series (Mumbai, India)

TEACHING

UC Berkeley

Graduate Student Instructor

PS236B	Quantitative Methodology in the Social Sciences: From Samples to Populations, PhD (2024)
PS231C	Model-based Inference and Machine Learning, PhD (2023)
PS231B	Design and Causal Inference, PhD (2023)
PS3	Introduction to Empirical Analysis and Quantitative Methods, Undergraduate (2022)

Evidence in Governance and Politics (EGAP)

Co-Instructor

Learning Days, Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire (2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026)
Training of the Trainers for Learning Days, Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire (2023, 2024, 2025, 2026)
Session on Estimation in R, remote (2024)
Refresher on Statistical Power, remote (2022)

SERVICE

Referee: *British Journal of Political Science*; *Comparative Political Studies*; *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*; *The Journal of Politics*; National Science Foundation.

Convener: EPSS Belfast Pre-Conference Workshop: "The Politics of South Asia" (2026), with Aliz Tóth and Simon Chauchard

Other: EGAP Learning Days participant selection, training of the trainers, and instructor (2022–2026), EGAP Priority Theme Grant editing support (2022), EGAP Global Fellowship Graduate Mentor (2022)

OTHER

Non-Academic Work Experience: World Bank Short-Term Consultant (2023-2025), USAID Consultant (2024), IDInsight (2023), US Department of State (2020-2021)

Fieldwork: India (Karnataka, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Telangana, U.P.), Côte d'Ivoire, Nepal

Language: English, French, Marathi (advanced), Hindi (beginner)

Nationality: USA, France